ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle)

KARAIKUDI

Date: 25.7.2017

A "Top Management Meet", an Orientation Programme on Entrepreneurship and Innovation for Chief Executives of Colleges and Polytechnics, was organized by the Department of Women's Studies, Alagappa University, Karaikudi, in collaboration with Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute, Government of Tamil Nadu, Chennai, today (25.7.2017).

Prof. K. Manimekalai, Dean, Faculty of Arts, in her thematic introduction, stated that Alagappa University entered into an MoU with the Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute (EDII), Chennai, on 20.06.2017 with a view to strengthening entrepreneurship education by imparting training to teachers so as to make their students to become entrepreneurially skilled and inspired entrepreneurs. Referring to this Meet, she said that the main objective is to initiate, encourage and sensitize the management of affiliated colleges of the University on the need to launch entrepreneurship education with a focus on creating entrepreneurs within and around the campus and create an aspiration for innovation among the students.

Presiding over the programme, Prof. V. Balachandran, Registrar i/c., Alagappa University, said that lakhs and lakhs of students are coming out of the portals of higher educational institutions year after year and all of them cannot be provided with jobs. So, it becomes imperative for institutions to train and motivate students for taking up entrepreneurship training. Quoting the words of Juan Roman of NASA, he stated that

innovation meant an honest integration of inspiration, perspiration and perseverance. He added that innovation can be new ideas, new approaches, new methods, new techniques and new processes. Realizing that "ideas" are at the core of modern economy, Corporate Sectors in well-developed countries spend enormous amount of money for getting **new ideas** from young minds and convert these new ideas into business proposals and produce new products for commercialization. He added that Alagappa University has currently evolved a plan of action to hone the inherent talents of rural youth to meet the rapidly changing needs, to bridge the gap between industry and academia and urban-rural divide. He focused on the efforts of both the Central and State Governments in this regard and made a reference to the contents of the 2020 Vision Document of Tamil Nadu.

Thiru R. Shiva Shankar, Deputy Director, Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute, Government of Tamil Nadu, Chennai, in his inaugural address, highlighted the aim of College Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Programmes of EDII. This programme, he added, aims at engaging the university community in entrepreneurship activities in order to create a positive and dynamic entrepreneurship and innovation eco-system within and around higher educational institutions. He said that its ultimate aim is to create "entrepreneurship hubs" and he added that resourceful universities and colleges will be recognized as hubs and each hub will support around 20 to 40 colleges. These hubs will play a key-role in developing an entrepreneurial eco-system that will allow students to be exposed to entrepreneurship and provide them with opportunities to develop their engagement till they start thriving as entrepreneurial individuals and entrepreneurs. He also said that EDII believes "in learning by doing methodology" and added that very soon entrepreneurship education will become part of the curriculum in Tamil Nadu.

40 participants, mostly Principals of Affiliated Colleges of Alagappa University, nearby Polytechnics and Engineering Colleges, attended the programme.

Dr. P. Veeramani, Assistant Professor, Centre for Women's Studies, proposed a vote of thanks.

Registrar i/c.

Prof. V. Balachandran